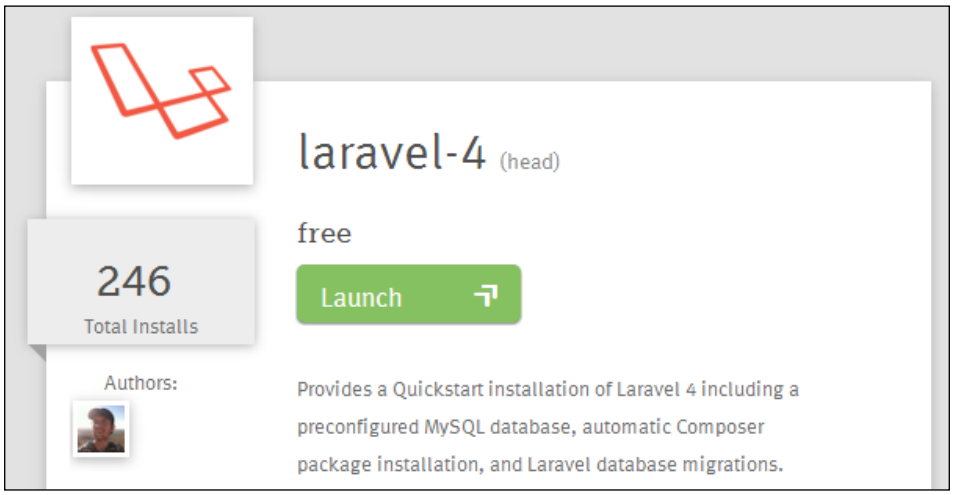
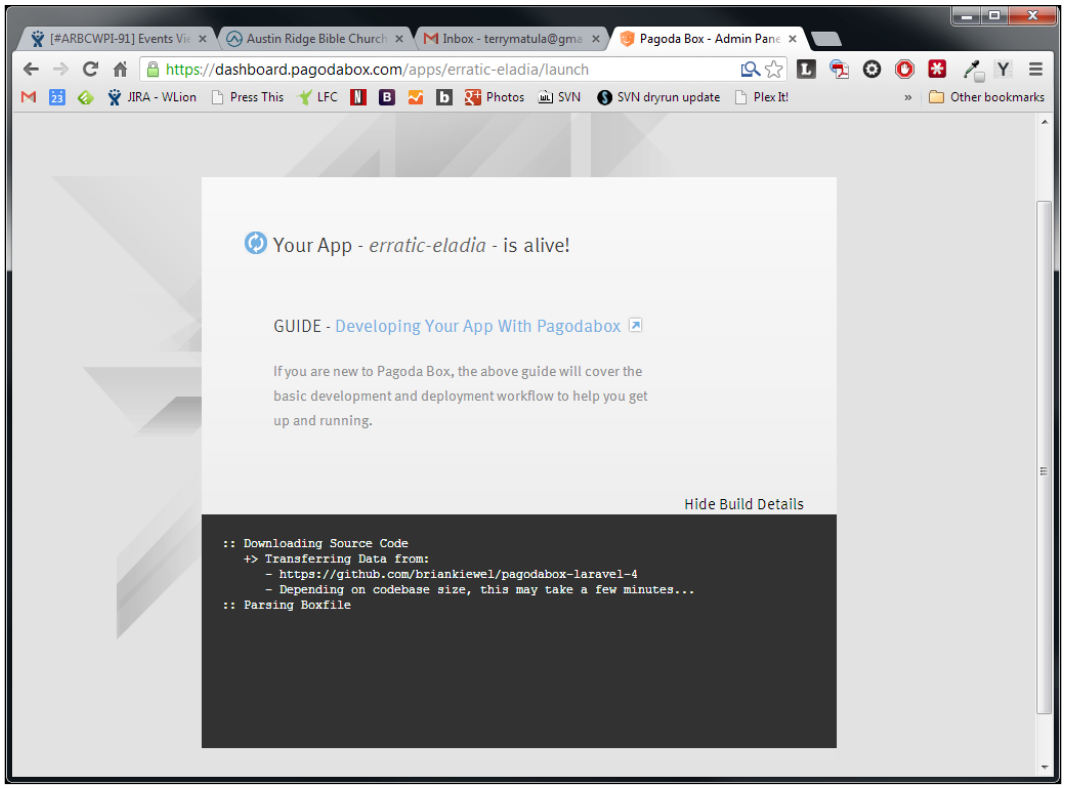
3. On the next page, click on the **Launch** button as shown in the following screenshot:



4. Wait for a few minutes while everything gets installed.



5. Once it's finished, click on the blue **Manage Your App** button as shown in the following screenshot:

6. Copy the git clone URL as shown in the following screenshot:

7. In the command line window, go to the root of your server and run the git clone command. In our case, it would be:

```
git clone git@git.pagodabox.com:erratic-eladia.git pagodaapp
```

8. After everything downloads, open the `app/routes.php` file and add a route so we can test it out as given in the following code:

```
Route::get('cool', function()
{
  return 'Pagoda Box is awesome!';
});
```

9. In the command line window, commit the following changes and send it back to the Pagoda Box

```
git commit -am 'Added route'
git push origin master
```

10. After Pagoda Box has finished the changes, go to the new route to see if it works. In our case, it will be `http://erratic-eladia.gopagoda.com/cool`.

How it works...

If we want to host our app and make sure it's scalable, we might want to look at a cloud hosting service. This will let us increase its performance if we happen to get an influx of traffic, and lower it when the traffic dies down. An excellent host that works well with PHP and Laravel is Pagoda Box. Pagoda Box also has a very nice free option that will allow us to test it out and create a full app without needing to pay.

To begin with, in the Pagoda Box dashboard, we create a new application and choose a Quickstart package we want to use. In the list is a handy Laravel 4 installation; if we choose it, everything will be installed for us, including all the dependencies.

After everything is set up, we can copy the git clone code and download the files to our local server. Once it's downloaded, we can do any updates and commit them. After pushing it back to Pagoda Box, our updated code will automatically be deployed and we will see the changes on the live site.

There's more...

There are other cloud hosting providers that work well with Laravel. They tend to all have free options so we can try them out. Some other hosts are as follows:

- Engine Yard `https://www.engineyard.com/`
- Digital Ocean `https://www.digitalocean.com/`
- Heroku (there's hidden PHP support) `https://www.heroku.com/`

Using the Stripe payment gateway with Laravel

E-commerce sites are a consistent staple in web development. In the past, things such as credit card processing have been difficult and the learning curve very steep. With Laravel and the Stripe service, offering credit card transactions is much easier.